MalikTrades

ADVANCED SETUPS

Rarer plays, for once the core three are second nature

THE PLAYBOOK

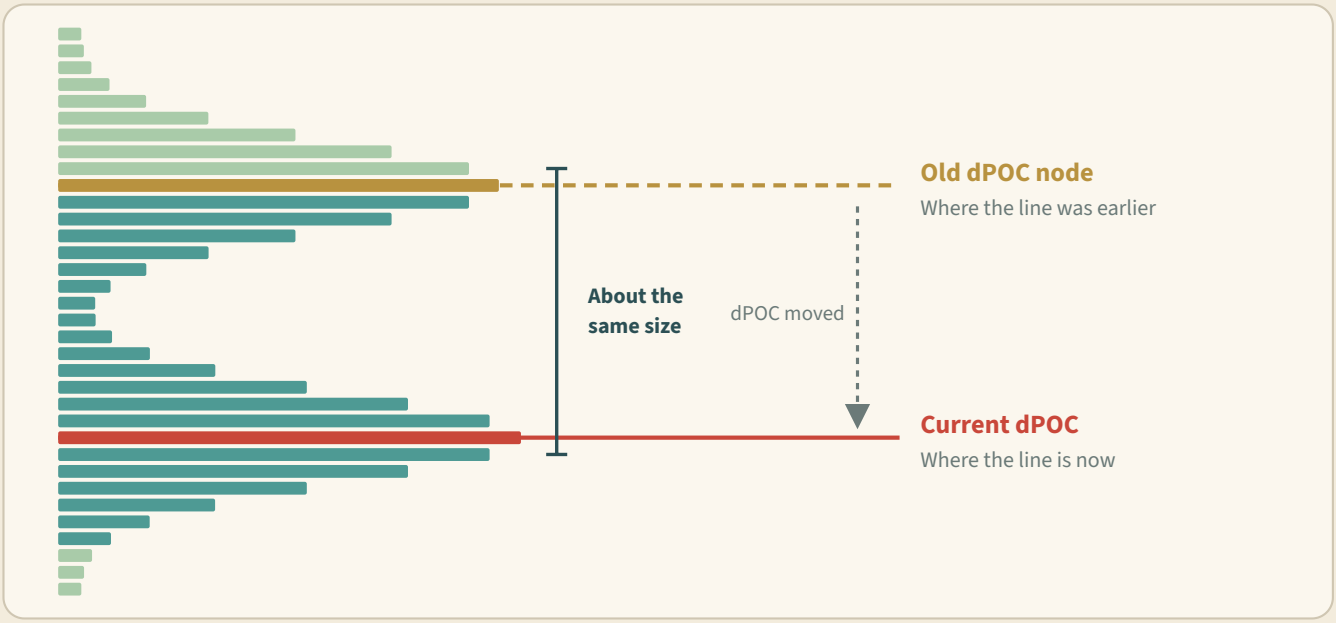
SETUP 04

The Anchor ⚓

The Magnet, at the old dPOC node.

ADVANCED · RARE

As the session builds, the dPOC can move. Volume builds at a new price, that node becomes the busiest, and the dPOC line jumps to it. But the old dPOC node doesn't disappear. If it's **about as big** as the current one, it's still just as much fair value.



The Anchor is a Magnet trade taken at that **old dPOC node**, not at the current dPOC line.

ONLY TAKE THE ANCHOR WHEN BOTH ARE TRUE

1. **The dPOC line has only recently shifted.** The move is fresh, so the old dPOC node is still live fair value.
2. **The actual volume is similar in both nodes.** Look at the bars, not the line. If the old dPOC node is clearly smaller, it isn't an Anchor.

READ THIS LAST

The Anchor builds on the Snap, the Flip and especially the Magnet. Make sure those feel obvious on your chart before you start looking for this one.

SETUP 04

Why It Works

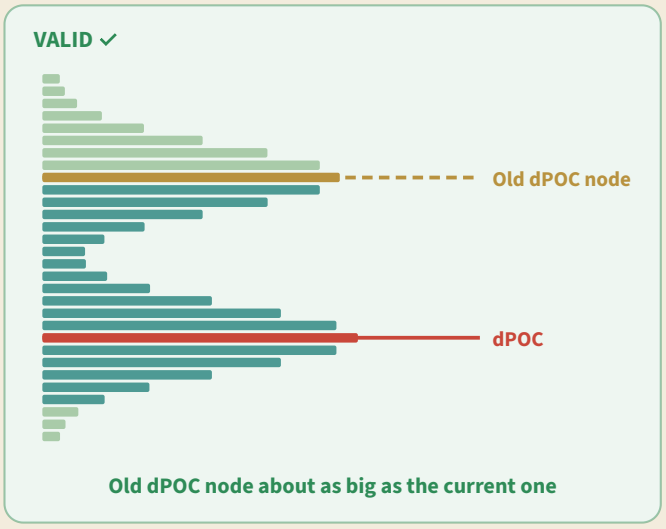
We trade volume, not the line.

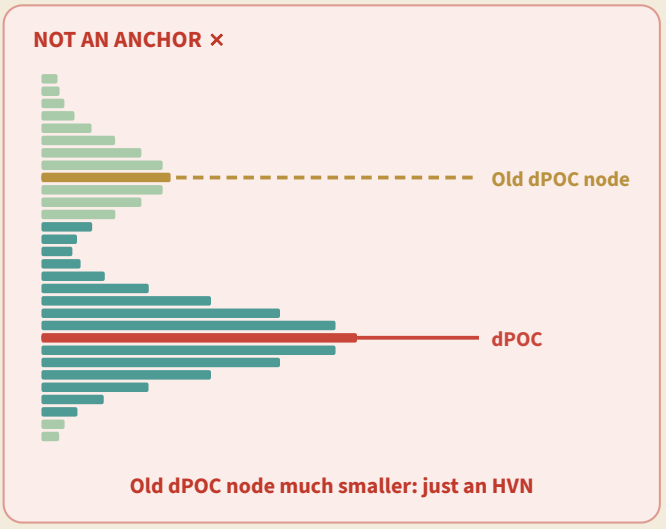
The POC line only marks the single busiest row in the profile. When two nodes are almost the same size, a tiny difference in volume decides which one gets the line. The market doesn't care which one the line sits on. Both are prices where a huge amount of business got done.

1. **Volume is what matters.** An old dPOC node that's as big as the current dPOC pulls price back in exactly the same way.

2. **The line can mislead you.** If you only watch the dPOC line, you'll miss a Magnet that's sitting at the old dPOC node.

3. **Same logic as the Magnet.** Price has accepted new prices, and the retest at fair value is where you join the move.





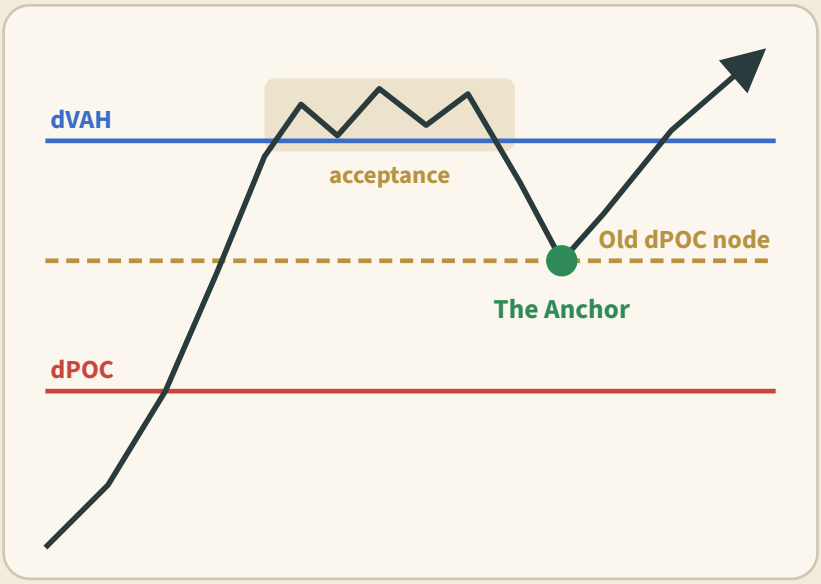
KEY TAKEAWAY

When the dPOC has just shifted and both nodes hold similar volume, the old dPOC node is still fair value. If it's clearly smaller, it's not an Anchor.

SETUP 04

How to Trade It

Same rules as the Magnet.



When it's valid

1. Price builds acceptance beyond the dVAH or dVAL, exactly like the Magnet.

2. The dPOC line has **only recently shifted**, and the actual volume is **similar in both nodes**.

3. Price comes back to the old dPOC node. Take the continuation the way price broke.

When it's not

Price snapped straight back from the dVAH or dVAL with no acceptance. No Magnet, no Anchor.

The old dPOC node is clearly smaller than the current one. That's an HVN, not fair value.

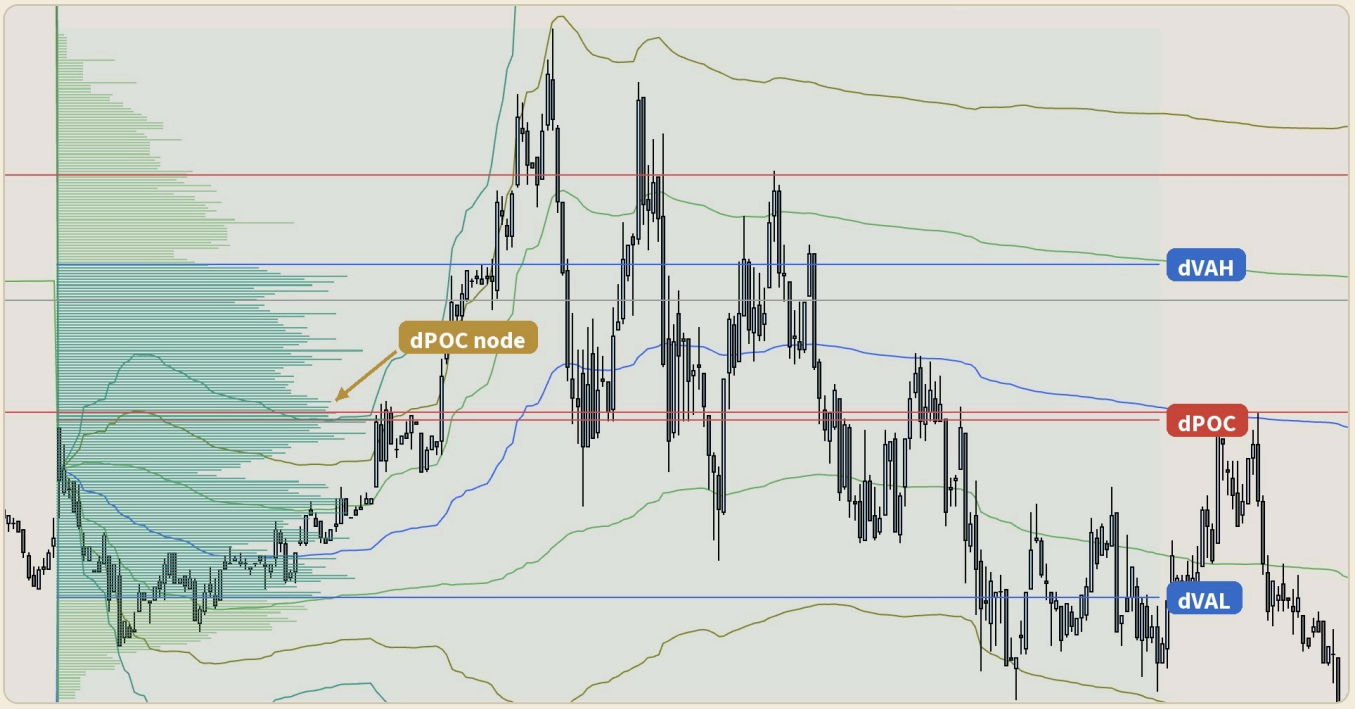
EXECUTION

Limit order at the old dPOC node, stop at ATR × 2 points, target 1:1, and breakeven at 75%. Same as every other setup (VP Academy #07).

The Anchor is still a Magnet trade, just at the old dPOC node. Common Mistakes #06 still applies: no dPOC trades outside the Magnet. The one exception is The Guard, in the London session only (page 15).

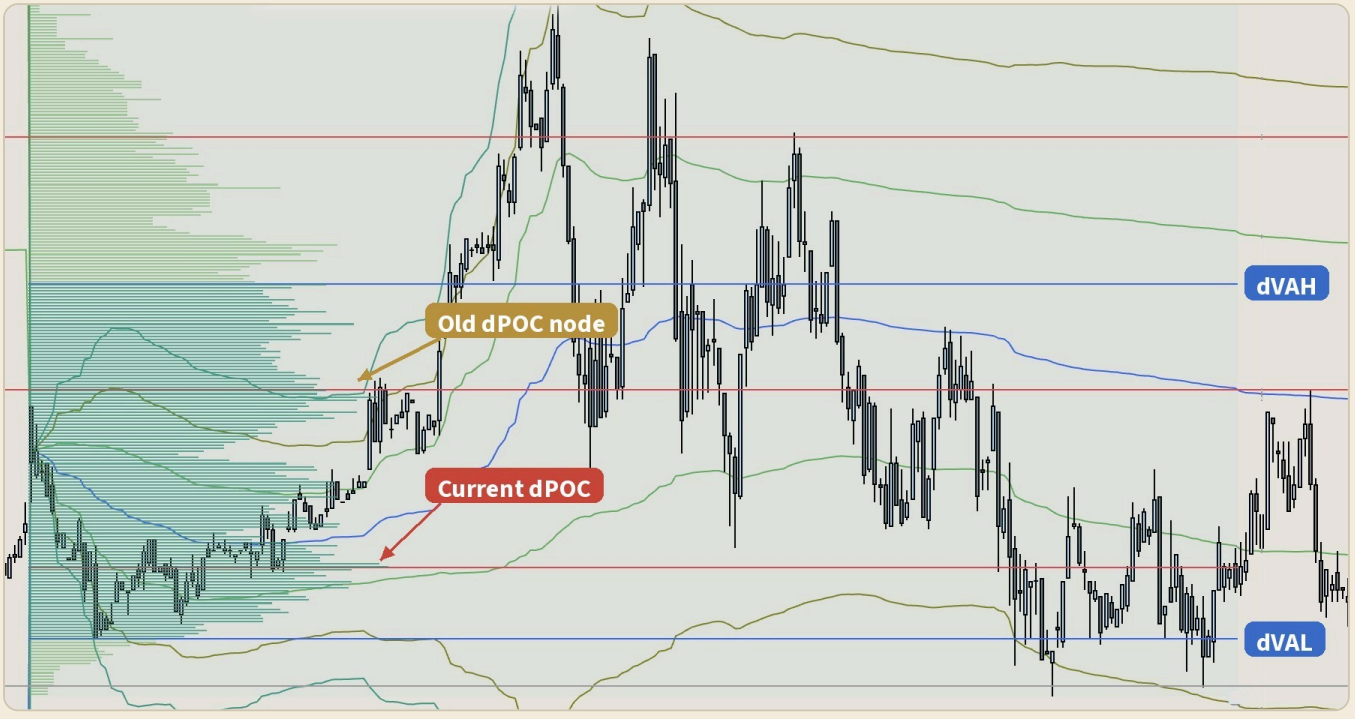
SETUP 04 · WORKED EXAMPLE

The Anchor, from a live session



1 Where the dPOC started

Early in the session, the dPOC built here, with a big node of volume behind it.



2 The dPOC moves down

Volume kept building lower and the dPOC line **recently shifted** down to the new node. The actual volume in the old dPOC node is still **similar** to the current one.

SETUP 04 · WORKED EXAMPLE

The Anchor, from a live session



3 The Anchor

Price came back to the original dPOC, the **old dPOC node**. The dPOC had only just shifted and both nodes held similar volume, so it was still fair value, and price had a clean reaction to the downside.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Watch the volume, not just the line. When the old dPOC node is as big as the current one, it's still fair value.

Education only, not financial advice.

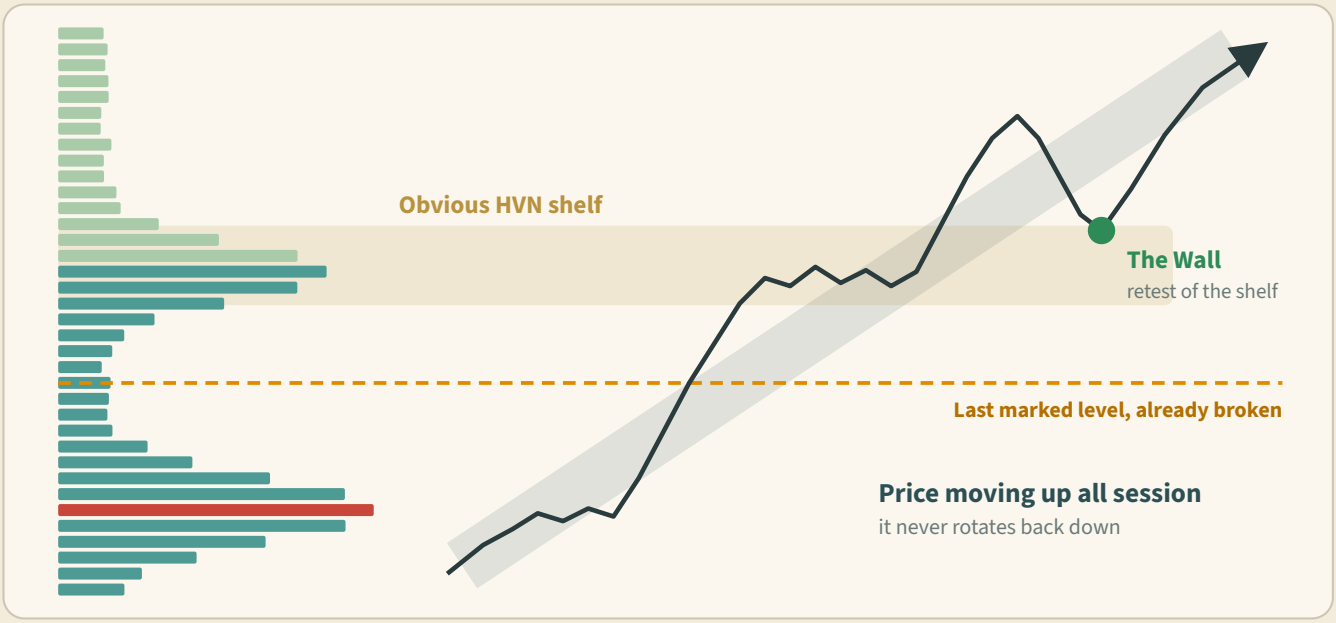
SETUP 05

The Wall

Riding the momentum off an HVN shelf.

ADVANCED · RARE

Some sessions only go one way. Price runs through your levels and keeps going, and before long there are **no marked levels left** to trade with the move. The Wall is how you keep trading that momentum.



Once your levels run out, the developing profile still shows you where price has done business on the way. An **obvious HVN shelf** is a pocket price is likely to react from, so you take the retest of it in the direction of the move. Think of the shelf as a **wall**: price runs back into it and bounces off, carrying on the way it was going.

ONLY TAKE THE WALL WHEN BOTH ARE TRUE

1. **Price has moved in one direction the entire session.** This is the one condition. No trend, no Wall.
2. **The HVN is an obvious shelf.** If you have to squint to find it, it isn't one.

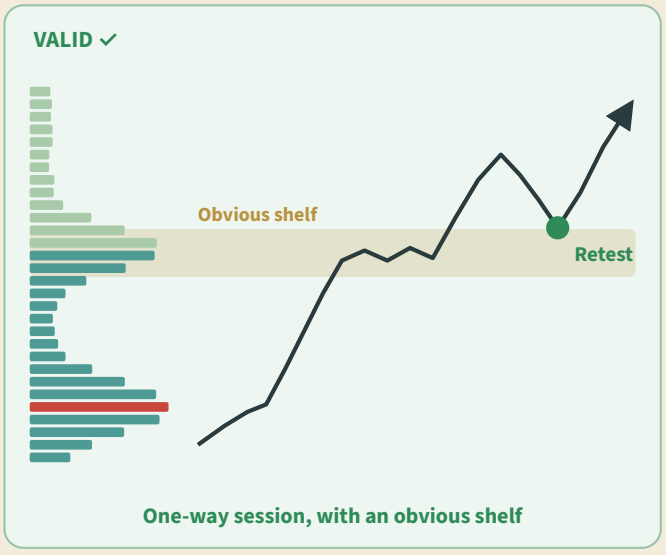
SETUP 05

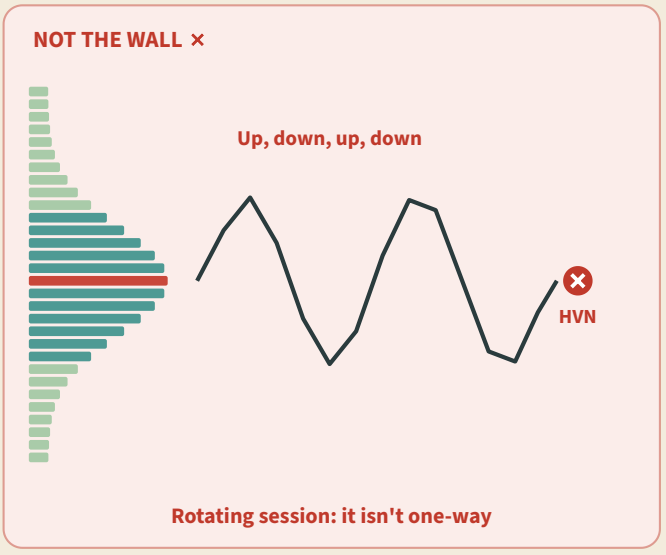
Why It Works

Trading the momentum, not fighting it.

On a trend day, the move itself is the edge. You don't want to fade it, and you don't want to stop trading it just because you ran out of levels. An HVN shelf is where price paused and built volume on the way, so it's one of the most probable places for price to bounce from when it pulls back.

1. **Momentum.** Price has gone one way all session. The Wall only ever trades **with** that move, as a continuation.
2. **A probable pocket.** An obvious shelf is an area of real business, so it tends to hold on the retest.
3. **Something to trade when the levels run out.** Your marked levels always come first. The Wall is for when there aren't any left.





KEY TAKEAWAY

One direction all session, no levels left, and an obvious HVN shelf. Take the retest of the shelf with the move.

SETUP 03

How to Trade It

Small, with the trend, off the shelf.

When it's valid

1. Price has moved in **one direction the entire session**.

2. There are no more marked levels to trade the continuation from.

3. The developing profile shows an **obvious HVN shelf**. When price comes back to it, take the retest in the direction of the move.

When it's not

The session has been rotating or balanced, like a D-shape. That isn't a one-way session, so there's no Wall.

The HVN isn't an obvious shelf, just a slightly thicker patch of the profile.

EXECUTION

Limit order at the edge of the HVN shelf, stop at ATR × 2 points, target 1:1, and breakeven at 75% (VP Academy #07). To be safe, it's ideal for your stop to **cover the whole HVN**, so it sits beyond the far side of the shelf and not inside it.

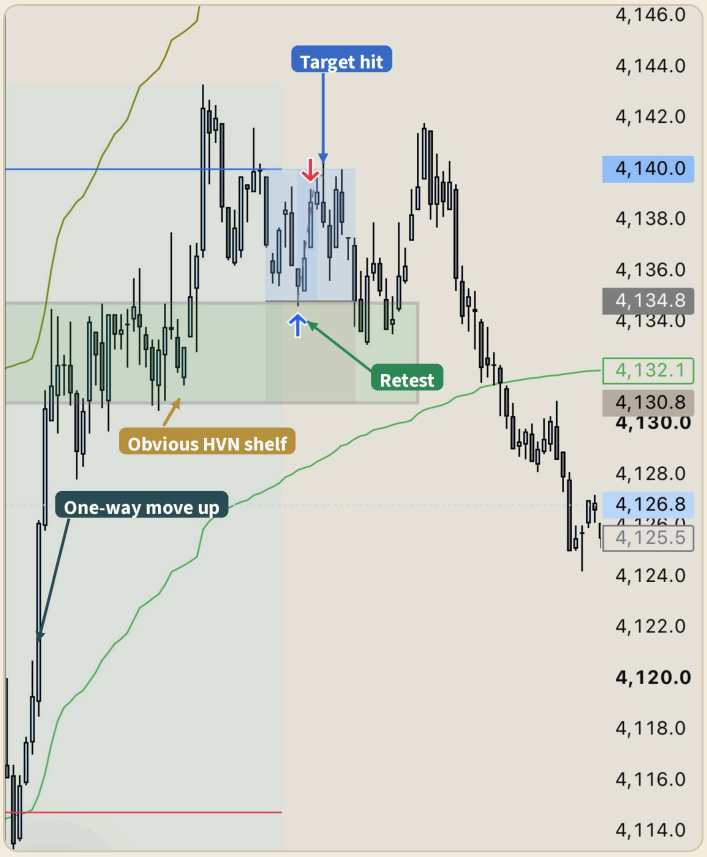
SIZE IT DOWN

On its own, the Wall is usually a 1★ setup, so treat it as a small continuation play. Size by the setup, never by your last result (Common Mistakes #12).

Don't mix this up with Common Mistakes #02. There, an HVN is building **against** your level and you're fading into it. With the Wall, you trade **with** a one-way move, off a shelf it already built.

SETUP 05 · WORKED EXAMPLE

The Wall, from a live session



1 One-way session

Gold had been moving up all session, so the only trades to take were continuations to the upside.

2 An obvious HVN shelf

There were no more marked levels above, but the developing profile had built an **obvious HVN shelf** (the green box).

3 The retest

Price came back down to the top of the shelf. I took a small continuation long off it.

4 Target hit

Price bounced off the shelf and hit the 1:1 target for **+1R**.

KEY TAKEAWAY

When the session only goes one way and your levels run out, an obvious HVN shelf gives you one more place to join the move.

Education only, not financial advice.

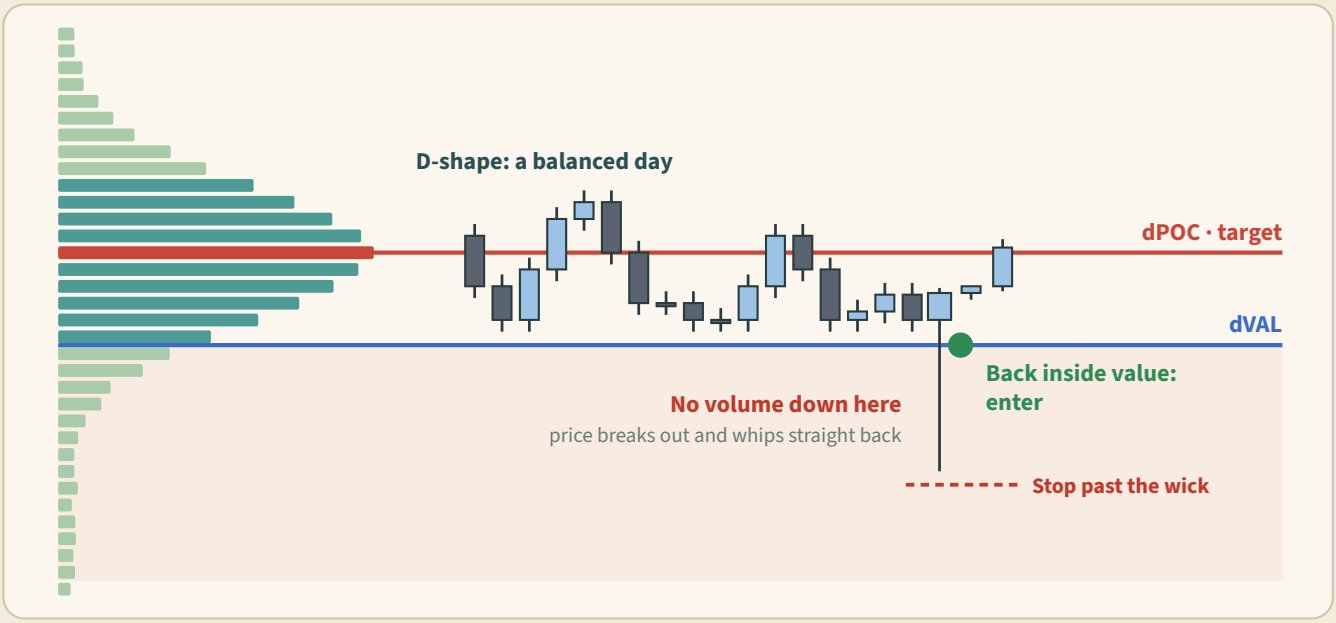
SETUP 06

The Whip ⚡

A fake breakout that whips straight back into value.

ADVANCED · RARE

On a D-shape day, price spends the session rotating inside value. Sometimes it breaks past the dVAH or dVAL, finds **nobody willing to trade out there**, and whips straight back in fast.



That fast rejection is the trade. As soon as price is back inside value, you enter back towards the middle of the D.

We take The Whip in the event where we lose on the D-shape. Your trade at the dVAH or dVAL gets stopped out by the breakout, and The Whip is how you get back in when that breakout fails.

ONLY TAKE THE WHIP WHEN ALL THREE ARE TRUE

1. **The profile is a D-shape**, a balanced day rotating around the dPOC. A **P-shape** on a bullish trending day or a **b-shape** on a bearish trending day also works (page 13).
2. **You've just lost on the profile.** Your trade at the dVAH or dVAL got stopped out as price broke through.
3. **Price breaks the dVAH or dVAL, puts in no volume, and whips back immediately.** Either the same candle or the next candle, without building volume outside.

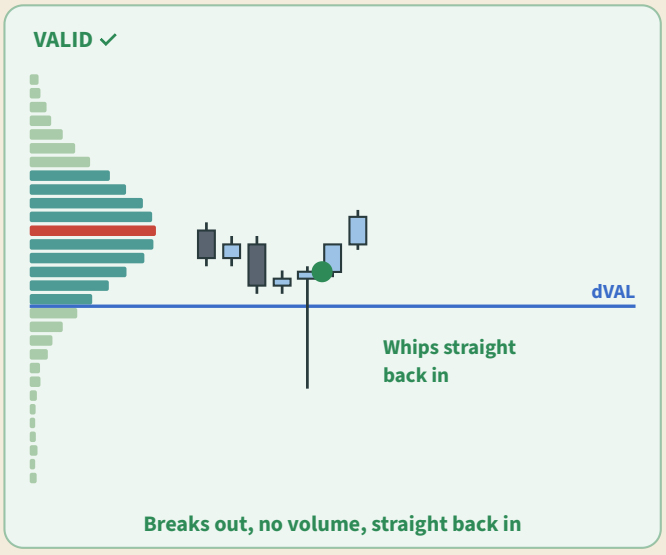
SETUP 06

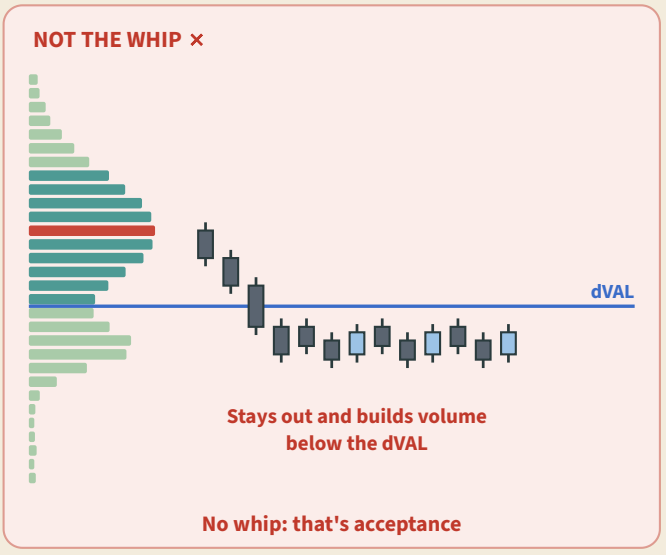
Why It Works

No volume means no acceptance.

On a balanced day, both buyers and sellers agree on value. When price pokes outside it, the market is asking a question: **is anyone willing to do business out here?** If no volume comes in and price snaps straight back, the answer is no. The breakout failed, and price tends to head back to fair value at the dPOC.

1. **Balance.** A D-shape day wants to stay inside value. The Whip trades back into that balance, not against it.
2. **Rejection.** No volume beyond the level means the move outside wasn't accepted. The fast whip back shows it.
3. **You can re-enter.** If a wick takes out your stop on the way out, it isn't over. If price whips back into value without building volume, you re-enter.





KEY TAKEAWAY

Break out, no volume, straight back in. That's The Whip. If price stays out and builds volume, it's acceptance instead.

SETUP 06

How to Trade It

Enter on the way back in.

When it's valid

1. The session has built a **D-shape** profile (or a P or b on a trending day), and you've **just lost** a trade on it at the dVAH or dVAL.

2. Price broke past the **dVAH or dVAL** and put in **no volume** out there.

3. Price **whips back into value immediately**. Either the same candle or the next candle. Enter as soon as it's back inside.

When it's not

Price breaks the dVAH or dVAL and **doesn't whip back immediately**.

Price stays outside and **puts in volume** above the dVAH or below the dVAL. That's acceptance, not a Whip, so watch for a Magnet instead.

EXECUTION

Enter as soon as price gets back inside value. Put your stop **past the wick**, beyond the low (or high) of the move outside value. Your target is the **dPOC**, a logical level inside value, or 1:1. Breakeven at 75% as usual (VP Academy #07).

LOST ON THE D-SHAPE? RE-ENTER

This is the whole point of The Whip. Your first entry gets stopped as price breaks out. If price then whips back into value **without putting in volume**, either the same candle or the next candle, the setup is still on, so re-enter as price gets back inside value. It's one setup with two entries, not revenge trading.

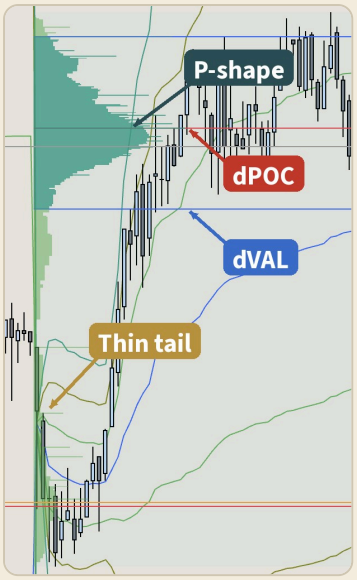
ALSO WORKS ON TRENDING DAYS

On a **bullish trending day** with a **P-shape**, value sits at the top. If price breaks below the dVAL, puts in no volume and whips back up, take The Whip **long**, with the trend. On a **bearish trending day** with a **b-shape**, it's the mirror image: price breaks above the dVAH, puts in no volume and whips back down, so take it **short**.

The Whip is the opposite of the Magnet. With the Magnet, price breaks out and **builds** volume, so you trade the continuation. With The Whip, price breaks out and builds **nothing**, so you trade back into value.

SETUP 06 · WORKED EXAMPLE

The Whip, from a live session



1 A P-shape on a bullish day

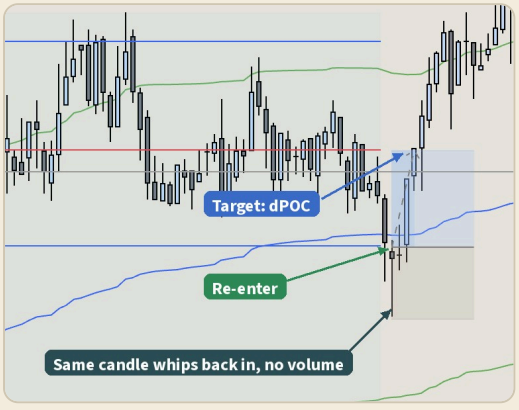
NQ had been trending up all session and built a **P-shaped profile**: value up top around the dPOC (red line), with a thin tail below from the move up.

With the trend up, the only Whip to look for is a break **below** the dVAL (blue line) that whips back up.



2 First entry, stopped out

I took a long just inside the dVAL (blue line), with the trend. Price broke below the dVAL and the wick took out my stop.



3 The whip

The **same candle** whipped straight back up into value, without putting in any volume below the dVAL.

4 Re-entry, target hit

I re-entered long as price got back inside value, with my stop past the wick. Price ran up to the **dPOC** for the win, and kept trending up after.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A stop-out on the wick doesn't kill The Whip. If price snaps back into value with no volume outside, take it again.

Education only, not financial advice.

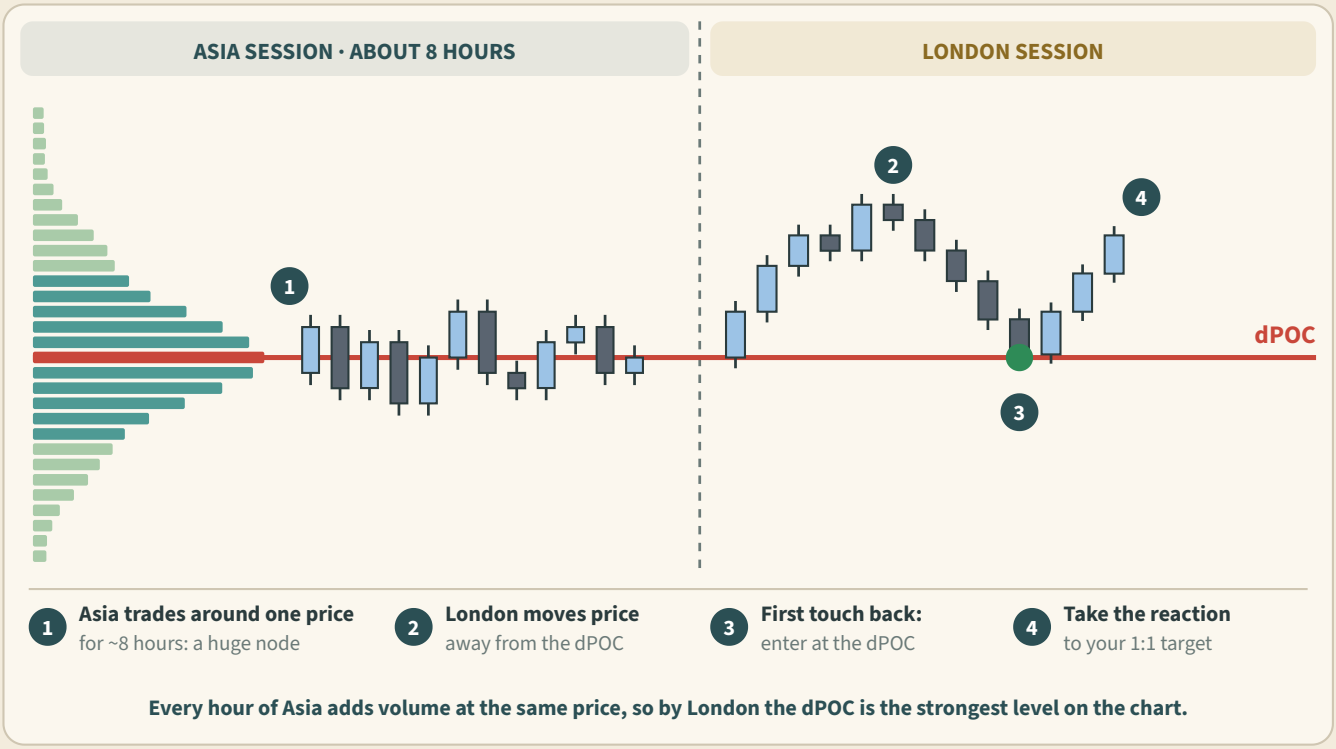
SETUP 07

The Guard 💂

The first London retest of a dPOC that's had all night to build.

ADVANCED · LONDON SESSION ONLY

By the time London opens, the developing profile has been building for **about 8 hours** through the Asia session. All that business has gone through one price, so the dPOC sits on a **huge node of volume** and has stopped moving around.



The Guard is the **first retest** of that dPOC after London has moved price away from it. Price comes back to the most agreed-on price of the day, the dPOC holds, and you trade the reaction back the way price came.

WHY I CALLED IT THE GUARD

Think of the guards outside Buckingham Palace. They stand at the **same post for hours** without moving, and when someone walks up to them, **they get turned away**. That's the dPOC by the London session: it's held the same price all night, and the first time price walks back up to it, it gets sent back. It's a London-only setup, so it gets a London name.

And like a real guard, it turns away the **first** approach, not a crowd that keeps coming back. That's why only the first touch counts.

SETUP 07

Why It Works

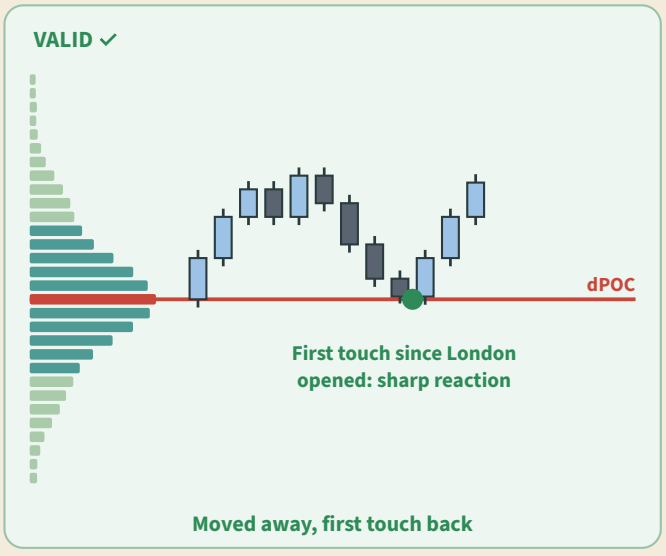
Eight hours of volume, defended on the first touch.

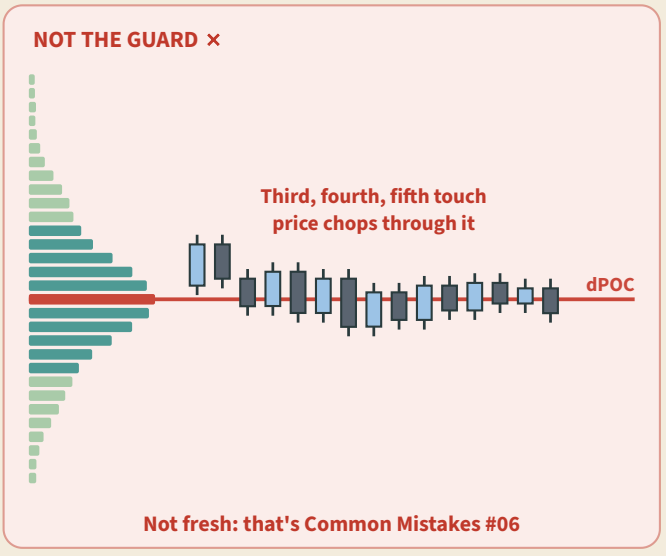
Common Mistakes #06 says the only dPOC trade I take is the Magnet, because the dPOC is a noisy place to trade. That's true **early in the day**, when there isn't much volume behind it and the line keeps jumping around. By London, it's a different level.

1. **It's had 8 hours to build.** The dPOC by London is the most heavily traded price of the day so far, with a huge node behind it. It isn't just the middle of the range any more.

2. **It's barely moving.** With that much volume behind it, a little extra business can't shift the line. You're trading a level that has stood still all night.

3. **The first touch gets defended.** The traders who built that node are still there. The first time price comes back, they defend it, so there's almost always a reaction.





KEY TAKEAWAY

By London, the dPOC has had all night to build. The first time price comes back to it, expect a reaction. Every touch after that is chop.

SETUP 07

How to Trade It

First touch only, then you're done with it.

ONLY TAKE THE GUARD WHEN ALL FOUR ARE TRUE

1. **It's the London session.** Not Asia, where the dPOC is still forming, and not New York.
2. **It's the first touch.** Price is trading away from the dPOC, and this is the first time it touches it in the London session.
3. **The dPOC hasn't just shifted.** It's been sitting at the same price, not jumping to a new node.
4. **Price didn't slice through it on the way out.** If it cut straight through the dPOC with no reaction, the market is looking for new value (Common Mistakes #03).

When it's valid

1. Price is trading **away** from the dPOC in London.

2. Price comes back to the dPOC for the **first time** in the session.

3. Take the reaction **back the way price came**: long if it came down to the dPOC, short if it came up to it.

When it's not

Later touches. Each one reacts **less** than the one before (see the worked example), and soon the dPOC is just chop (Common Mistakes #06).

The dPOC has just jumped to a new node. That's an Anchor situation, not a Guard.

It's a trend day and the dPOC keeps moving with price.

EXECUTION

Limit order at the dPOC, stop at ATR × 2 points, target 1:1, and breakeven at 75%. Same as every other setup (VP Academy #07).

BASE HITS, NOT HOME RUNS

The objective of this whole framework is to capture **small moves**, base hits. The Guard is no different. We're **not expecting a big move** off the dPOC. It can happen, but that's a bonus. What we're trading is the **reaction** from the dPOC on the first touch, which is very likely, and a 1:1 target is all we need from it.

The Guard is the **one exception** to Common Mistakes #06, and it only exists in the London session. Outside London, the rule stands: the only dPOC trade is the Magnet.

SETUP 07 · WORKED EXAMPLE

The Guard, from a live session



1 First touch: short

ES had been trading **below the dPOC** (the red line), which had been building all through the Asia session. In London, price rallied up to it for the **first time**, and I went short at the dPOC with a 1:1 target.

2 The reaction

The dPOC held. Price dropped to my target and kept going, about **6 points**, well past 1:1. That's the reaction The Guard is built on.

3 Second touch: a smaller reaction

Price came back up to the dPOC a second time. It reacted again, **just less**, and I managed to take a small profit on it.

4 Then it gave way

Straight after, price pushed **through** the dPOC. Each touch reacted less than the one before.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The first touch gave the big, clean reaction. The second still reacted, but less, and then the dPOC gave way. The first touch is the trade. Anything after it is a smaller play, not the setup.

ES, 1-minute chart. Education only, not financial advice.